

to have of you. If you try to project the image of a successful businessman or woman, it is imperative that you project an image of wealth. The type of car you drive, the clothes you wear, the home you live in, and your choice of activities all must fit this image. Sometimes the pressure to create a certain image is self-imposed, but other times you may feel you do not have a choice but to appear to be the kind of person your surroundings dictate. This causes many people to get in way over their heads with payments they can ill afford.

Take the case of Phil. He had purchased a brand new, luxury foreign car that he couldn't afford. At the age of twenty-two, he had recently graduated from college and his first entry-level job only paid him \$36,000 a year. The car he just bought was equal to an entire year's salary! When asked what possessed him to purchase a car he couldn't afford, Phil replied that he really hadn't even planned on buying a new car, he had simply wanted to test drive the new model. The hook happened during his test drive.

As Phil was driving, he noticed women honking and waving at him. Being single, Phil enjoyed this attention and noticed that he never got this reaction when he drove his old used car. Phil could feel his self-confidence increasing as he continued his test drive. When he arrived back at the dealership, the salesman remarked how sharp Phil looked behind the wheel. Phil looked in the rear view mirror and agreed.

Before he knew what had happened, Phil had signed the loan papers and driven his new car off the lot. He took a seven-year loan so that he could afford the monthly payments. He confessed later that he felt powerless to stop himself. His recollection was fuzzy; it seemed like a dream. The car in the driveway the next morning assured him that it was not.

Decisions are usually made with both emotional and logical reasoning involved. Sometimes logic is more compelling

